

**SATYADHEESH**
सत्याधीश

UPSC DAILY DETAILED NOTES

Current Affairs • 2 October 2026**44**

NOTES

8

STORIES MERGED

10

MCQS

GS1 • 4

GS2 • 18

GS3 • 22

PAPER MIX

CONTENTS**Every note, grouped by paper****GS1 History • Society • Geography**

4 notes

History & Culture

2

Geography

2

GS2 Polity • Governance • Social Justice • IR

18 notes

Polity & Constitution

4

Governance

3

Social Justice

5

International Relations

6

GS3 Economy • S&T • Environment • Security

22 notes

Economy

7

Agriculture

3

Science & Technology

7

Environment & Ecology

4

Internal Security

1

Practice — 10 MCQs**HOW EACH NOTE READS**

Why in news → facts to remember → a Mains question with keywords. Duplicate stories are merged.

SHORT ON TIME?

The 5-page **Brief** has the stories that matter most, plus a quiz. Same day, same notes.

History & Culture

2

MODERN INDIA & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

P

M

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129424

Mahatma Gandhi led Non-Cooperation and Dandi March movements

WHY IN NEWS Commemoration of Mahatma Gandhi's 157th birth anniversary highlighting his leadership in the Non-Cooperation and Dandi March movements.

PERSON	Mahatma Gandhi — Lawyer by profession who led the Indian freedom movement.
PLACE	Porbandar — Birthplace of Mahatma Gandhi in Gujarat.
CONCEPT	Salt Satyagraha — Another name for the Dandi March.
DATE	30 January 1948 — Date of Mahatma Gandhi's assassination in Delhi.

MAINS Q Analyze how Mahatma Gandhi's philosophy of Satyagraha and Non-Cooperation served as a catalyst for the mass mobilization of the Indian freedom struggle.

USE: Satyagraha Non-Cooperation Mass Mobilization Salt Satyagraha Non-violence

MODERN INDIA & FREEDOM STRUGGLE

P

M

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129332

British East India Company defeated Maratha army to seize Delhi in 1803

WHY IN NEWS Historical analysis of the British East India Company's 1803 victory over the Marathas and the subsequent colonial land settlements in Delhi.

EVENT	1803 victory: British East India Company defeated the Maratha army to seize control of Delhi.
DATE	1837: Revenue surveys conducted to systematically classify land in the Delhi region.
DATE	1880: Settlement of Kanjhawala replaced customary rights with systematic land classification.
PLACE	Kanjhawala and Raisina: Historical localities in Delhi impacted by colonial and modern urban development.

MAINS Q Analyze how colonial land revenue systems and urban planning in Delhi altered traditional land-use patterns and communal rights during the 19th and 20th centuries.

USE: Colonial land tenure Revenue settlement Urban displacement Customary rights Land classification

Geography

2

PLACES IN NEWS / MAPPING

P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129419

India identifies 28 strategic places and geographical features on official map

WHY IN NEWS The Government of India formally identified 28 strategic places and geographical features on the official Survey of India map to ensure accurate recognition of territory.

BODY	Survey of India (Sol) — the national survey and mapping agency of India
PLACE	Zorawar Peak and Kanishka Peak — strategic geographical features in the Ladakh region
PLACE	Parpik and Skamri — glaciers identified on the official map
FIGURE	28 — total number of strategic places and geographical features identified

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of accurate cartographic representation in safeguarding India's territorial integrity and managing border security in high-altitude regions.

USE: Cartographic sovereignty Territorial integrity Strategic mapping Border management Geospatial data

Gandak River breaches and Shitalpur dam flood five Bihar districts

WHY IN NEWS Heavy flooding in Bihar caused by Gandak River embankment breaches and Shitalpur dam overflow, necessitating large-scale rescue operations by NDRF and IAF.

PLACE	Gandak River — A major river in Bihar that flows into the Ganges
CONCEPT	Highest Flood Level (HFL) — The water level remained above this for 24 to 36 hours
PLACE	Saran, Gopalganj, Muzaffarpur, West Champaran, and East Champaran — Districts affected by the 2026 flood
BODY	NDRF — National Disaster Response Force, a specialized force for disaster management

MAINS Q *Analyze the structural and hydrological challenges in managing riverine flood risks in the Gangetic plains and suggest measures to enhance disaster resilience.*

USE:

Flood Mitigation

Disaster Resilience

Hydrological Modeling

Embankment Integrity

Inter-agency Coordination

Polity & Constitution

4

ELECTIONS, ECI & ELECTORAL REFORMS

P

3 REPORTS MERGED

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129344

ECI directs special drive to re-enroll voters after 13.3 crore names deleted

WHY IN NEWS The Election Commission of India directed Chief Electoral Officers to conduct a special drive to re-enroll eligible voters following the deletion of 13.3 crore names from voter lists.

BODY	Election Commission of India (ECI) — Constitutional body responsible for administering elections to Parliament and State Legislatures
CONCEPT	Form 6 — The specific application form used for the enrollment of new voters in the electoral roll
PERSON	Chief Electoral Officers (CEOs) — Primary state-level authorities responsible for conducting elections in States/UTs
FIGURE	13.3 crore — Number of names deleted from voter lists leading to the rectification drive

MAINS Q *Examine the challenges in maintaining an accurate and inclusive electoral roll in India and suggest measures to ensure universal suffrage.*

USE: Universal Adult Franchise Electoral Roll Constitutional Mandate Inclusivity Demographic Accuracy

CONSTITUTION, AMENDMENTS & BASIC STRUCTURE

P

M

2 Oct · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/129714

Gujarat receives presidential assent for Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026

WHY IN NEWS Gujarat became the second state after Uttarakhand to receive presidential assent for its Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill 2026, unifying personal laws for residents.

ACT	Gujarat UCC Bill 2026 — Unifies rules for marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships.
CONCEPT	Scheduled Tribes exclusion — The bill explicitly excludes Scheduled Tribes to preserve their customary rights.
FIGURE	Marriageable age — Set at 21 years for men and 18 years for women under the new law.
BODY	Marriage registration — Mandates registration within 60 days and prohibits polygamy.

MAINS Q *Examine the constitutional challenges and social implications of implementing a Uniform Civil Code in a diverse country like India while balancing personal laws and tribal rights.*

USE: Uniform Civil Code Article 44 Personal Laws Scheduled Tribes Legal Uniformity

STATUTORY, REGULATORY & QUASI-JUDICIAL BODIES

P

M

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129425

Kerala High Court rules against mandatory DNA tests for undisputed paternity

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court ruled against mandatory DNA testing for correcting birth records in cases of undisputed paternity, urging legislative amendments to the Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969.

ACT	Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969 — Central legislation governing the recording of vital statistics in India.
CONCEPT	Rule 11 of Kerala Registration of Births and Deaths Rules, 1999 — State rule governing the correction of birth records.
BODY	Kerala High Court — State judiciary overseeing the application of registration rules in Kerala.

MAINS Q *Discuss the balance between the state's interest in accurate civil registration and the protection of individual privacy and dignity in correcting vital records.*

USE: Right to Privacy Civil Registration Legislative Amendment Bodily Integrity Administrative Law

Kerala High Court directs Speaker to disqualify Pala MLA Mani C. Kappan

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court directed the Speaker to disqualify MLA Mani C. Kappan following his conviction in cheque-bounce cases, highlighting the application of the Representation of People Act.

ACT	Representation of People Act, 1951 — Governs the disqualification of members of Parliament and State Legislatures.
CONCEPT	Speaker of the State Legislative Assembly — The presiding officer responsible for deciding on disqualification petitions.
PERSON	Mani C. Kappan — Convicted in four cheque-bounce cases and sentenced to 3.5 years imprisonment.
FIGURE	₹3.25 crore — The fine amount exceeding the conviction in the cheque-bounce cases.

MAINS Q Discuss the constitutional and statutory framework governing the disqualification of legislators in India. How does it ensure the integrity of the legislative body?

USE:

Disqualification

Representation of People Act

Judicial Review

Legislative Integrity

Constitutional Mandate

Governance

3

Telangana Government to release ₹2,500 crore in pending DA instalments

WHY IN NEWS The Telangana Government announced the release of two pending dearness allowance (DA) instalments worth ₹2,500 crore to state employees.

FIGURE	₹2,500 crore — amount of the two pending DA instalments being released.
DATE	July 1, 2023 — the date from which the pending DA instalments have been due.
CONCEPT	Dearness Allowance (DA) — a cost-of-living adjustment to salaries for state employees.
PERSON	N. Siva Sankar — head of the Pay Revision Commission in Telangana.

MAINS Q Discuss the fiscal implications and administrative challenges of implementing periodic dearness allowance revisions for state government employees in India.

USE:

Fiscal Federalism

Dearness Allowance

Public Finance

Wage Revision

State Budgetary Allocation

Supreme Court orders blacklisting of vehicles with ₹49,194.05 crore in unpaid fines

WHY IN NEWS The Supreme Court mandated states to block services and blacklist vehicles for motorists with ₹49,194.05 crore in unpaid fines to improve enforcement of traffic regulations.

CONCEPT	Blacklisting: Action to block services and blacklist vehicles on the Parivahan portal for unpaid fines.
FIGURE	₹49,194.05 crore: Total amount of unpaid fines across states ordered for blocking.
FIGURE	99.22 lakh: Number of unpaid challans reported in Hyderabad by late 2025.
BODY	Parivahan: The national portal for vehicle-related services in India.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in enforcing traffic regulations in urban centers and evaluate the effectiveness of digital platforms like Parivahan in ensuring fiscal compliance.

USE:

Fiscal compliance

Digital governance

Regulatory enforcement

Judicial activism

Public accountability

Kerala High Court orders Travancore Devaswom Board to improve pilgrim infrastructure

WHY IN NEWS The Kerala High Court directed the Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB) to improve pilgrim infrastructure and grievance redressal mechanisms at Erumely.

BODY	Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB) — A statutory body responsible for the administration of Sabarimala and related shrines.
PLACE	Erumely — A significant pilgrimage site in the Pathanamthitta district of Kerala.
CONCEPT	Digital Infrastructure — Court mandated CCTV surveillance and a mobile booking app with UPI payment integration.

MAINS Q Discuss the role of judicial activism in ensuring the provision of basic amenities and grievance redressal mechanisms for pilgrims in religious sites.

USE: [Judicial Oversight](#) [Public Amenities](#) [Grievance Redressal](#) [Digital Infrastructure](#) [Statutory Bodies](#)

Social Justice

5

VULNERABLE SECTIONS (SC/ST, MINORITIES, DISABLED, ELDERLY, CHILDREN) P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129461

2 REPORTS MERGED

Tamil Nadu launches Vettri Payanam for free bus travel for women and transgender persons

WHY IN NEWS Tamil Nadu CM launched the 'Vettri Payanam' scheme to provide free bus travel for women and transgender persons across seven State Transport Corporations.

SCHEME	Vettri Payanam — Tamil Nadu state government scheme providing free bus travel for women and transgender persons
FIGURE	12,695 buses — The number of buses covered under the scheme across seven State Transport Corporations
FIGURE	84.32 lakh — The target number of women and transgender persons to benefit daily
PLACE	Koyambedu — Major bus terminus in Chennai where the scheme was launched

MAINS Q Discuss how targeted social welfare schemes like free public transport can facilitate gender equality and economic inclusion for marginalized communities in India.

USE: [Gender Equality](#) [Social Inclusion](#) [Public Welfare](#) [Economic Empowerment](#) [Mobility Rights](#)

VULNERABLE SECTIONS (SC/ST, MINORITIES, DISABLED, ELDERLY, CHILDREN) P M

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129509

Kerala announces separate housing scheme for SC/ST to bypass Life Mission delays

WHY IN NEWS Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan announced a separate housing scheme for SC/ST communities to bypass delays in the Life Mission project.

SCHEME	Life Mission: A flagship housing scheme by the Government of Kerala to provide homes for the homeless.
FIGURE	₹500 crore: Additional amount allocated by the Kerala government for SC/ST welfare schemes in the 2026 budget.
PLACE	Wayanad: Site proposed for the establishment of the world's first tribal university.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of targeted housing schemes for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in achieving inclusive growth and social justice in India.

USE: [Social Justice](#) [Inclusive Growth](#) [Targeted Welfare](#) [Land Reform](#) [Tribal Empowerment](#)

Kerala hospitals face drug shortages as KMSCL owes pharma firms over ₹2,200 crore

WHY IN NEWS Kerala hospitals are facing critical shortages of essential non-communicable disease drugs due to a ₹2,200 crore debt owed by the Kerala Medical Services Corporation Limited (KMSCL) to pharmaceutical firms.

BODY	KMSCL: A Kerala state government undertaking for procuring and distributing medicines to public health facilities.
CONCEPT	NCD Management: Shortages specifically affect drugs for non-communicable diseases like diabetes and hypertension.
FIGURE	₹2,200 crore: The outstanding debt owed by KMSCL to pharmaceutical firms as of 2024.
EVENT	Direct Sourcing: State government allows direct importers to bypass middlemen to complete procurement by December 2024.

MAINS Q Analyze the systemic bottlenecks in public procurement of essential medicines and suggest measures to ensure supply chain resilience in state-run healthcare systems.

USE: Public Procurement Supply Chain Resilience Fiscal Arrears NCD Management Direct Sourcing

Andhra Pradesh HRD Minister directs SEEDAP to target 1 lakh youth annually

WHY IN NEWS Andhra Pradesh HRD Minister Nara Lokesh directed the State Employment Exchange Department (SEEDAP) to target the annual employment of 1 lakh youth to boost state-level job placement.

BODY	SEEDAP: State Employment Exchange Department of Andhra Pradesh
FIGURE	76% placement rate reported for Andhra Pradesh skill development programs
FIGURE	5.43 lakh youth have secured jobs through skill development initiatives in Andhra Pradesh

MAINS Q Discuss the role of state-led skill development and employment exchange departments in addressing the structural mismatch between educational output and industrial demand in India.

USE: Skill Development Employment Exchange Human Capital Vocational Training Placement Rate

Kerala Health Minister initiates committee to draft Bill regulating private hospital costs

WHY IN NEWS Kerala Health Minister K. Muraleedharan initiated a committee to draft a Bill regulating medicine costs and room rents in private hospitals to address public complaints over exorbitant healthcare expenses.

BODY	KMSCL — Kerala Medical Services Corporation Limited, a state-run body for medicine procurement
CONCEPT	Price Ceiling — The proposed Bill aims to regulate medicine costs, diagnostic charges, and room rents
FIGURE	Committee Composition — 4 members including Director of Health Services and Director of Medical Education

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in regulating private healthcare costs in India while ensuring the quality of service and the sustainability of private healthcare providers.

USE: Affordability Regulatory Framework Public Health Governance Price Ceiling Healthcare Accessibility

India and Canada initiate fifth round of CEPA negotiations

WHY IN NEWS India and Canada have initiated the fifth round of Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) negotiations to scale bilateral trade to USD 70 billion by 2031.

CONCEPT	CEPA: Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement being negotiated between India and Canada
FIGURE	USD 70 billion: Target bilateral trade volume between India and Canada by 2031
FIGURE	USD 30 billion: Current bilateral trade baseline between India and Canada
PLACE	Ottawa: Location of the fifth round of CEPA negotiations

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) in diversifying India's supply chains and enhancing its energy security through bilateral trade with Canada.

USE: [Bilateral Trade](#) [Supply Chain Diversification](#) [Critical Minerals](#) [Economic Partnership](#) [Trade Liberalization](#)

Putin acknowledges Modi's mediation ideas for Ukraine conflict

WHY IN NEWS President Vladimir Putin acknowledged Prime Minister Narendra Modi's mediation efforts regarding the Ukraine conflict during the Valdai Discussion Club.

CONCEPT	Multi-alignment — India's policy of maintaining strategic autonomy and mediating global tensions
CONCEPT	Strategic Autonomy — India's approach to independent decision-making in foreign policy
EVENT	Ukraine conflict — commenced in February 2022
BODY	Valdai International Discussion Club — A Russian forum for international dialogue

MAINS Q Analyze India's role as a 'bridge' in the Ukraine conflict and discuss the significance of its 'multi-aligned' foreign policy in mediating global geopolitical tensions.

USE: [Strategic Autonomy](#) [Multi-alignment](#) [Peace Mediation](#) [Geopolitical Equilibrium](#) [Global South Leadership](#)

Chhattisgarh and Odisha CMs meet Amit Shah to resolve Mahanadi water dispute

WHY IN NEWS Chief Ministers of Chhattisgarh and Odisha met Union Home Minister Amit Shah to resolve the long-standing Mahanadi water dispute through a technical committee and tribunal.

BODY	Central Water Commission (CWC) — Apex body under Ministry of Jal Shakti for water resources management.
PLACE	Mahanadi River — Major river in eastern India flowing through Chhattisgarh and Odisha.
PERSON	Bela M. Trivedi — Current head of the Mahanadi Water Disputes Tribunal.

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in inter-state river water sharing in India and the role of statutory tribunals in resolving such disputes.

USE: [Inter-state water sharing](#) [Federalism](#) [Riparian rights](#) [Statutory Tribunal](#) [Hydrological security](#)

Global Alliance formed in Bengaluru to tackle diabetic foot cases

WHY IN NEWS A global alliance was formed in Bengaluru on October 2, 2026, to combat diabetic foot complications and limb preservation through international cooperation.

CONCEPT	Global Alliance for Diabetic Foot Survival and Limb Preservation — a multi-lateral initiative to address 18.6 million annual diabetic foot cases.
PLACE	Bengaluru — the host city for the alliance formation on October 2, 2026.
BODY	DFSI — the Diabetic Foot Society of India is a key member of the alliance.
BODY	WHO — the alliance will collaborate with the World Health Organization for advocacy and data.

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of multi-lateral healthcare alliances in addressing non-communicable diseases (NCDs) and the role of international cooperation in improving surgical outcomes in developing nations.

USE: Non-communicable diseases Multi-lateral cooperation Limb preservation Public health advocacy Standardized data collection

World food prices hit four-year high due to logistics and El Nino

WHY IN NEWS The FAO reported a surge in world food prices to a four-year high in September 2024 due to logistical bottlenecks and climate phenomena.

BODY	FAO: Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
FIGURE	136.0 points: The average level of the FAO Food Price Index in September 2024
PLACE	Strait of Hormuz: A strategic chokepoint in the Persian Gulf affected by logistics disruptions
CONCEPT	El Niño: A climate pattern involving the warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean

MAINS Q Analyze how global geopolitical tensions and climate change interact to destabilize international food security and impact the economies of developing nations.

USE: Food Security Commodity Volatility Geopolitical Risk Climate Resilience Supply Chain Disruption

Nile perch introduction in Lake Victoria destroyed 200 native fish species

WHY IN NEWS The National Invasive Species Information Center reported that the 1954 introduction of Nile perch into Lake Victoria led to the destruction of approximately 200 native fish species.

CONCEPT	Nile perch: An invasive predatory fish species introduced for commercial fishing.
PLACE	Lake Victoria: A transboundary water body shared by Kenya, Tanzania, and Uganda.
FIGURE	200: The approximate number of native fish species, primarily cichlids, destroyed.

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological and economic trade-offs involved in introducing invasive species for commercial purposes in shared transboundary water bodies.

USE: Invasive species Biodiversity loss Transboundary water management Ecological impact Cichlids

Economy

7

CAPITAL MARKETS & SEBI

P

2 REPORTS MERGED

2 Oct · NDTV · satyadheesh.in/news/129363**SEBI study reveals 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses**

WHY IN NEWS SEBI's FY25-26 study revealed that 87.7% of individual equity derivative traders incurred net losses, highlighting risks in retail participation in complex financial instruments.

BODY	SEBI — Primary regulator for the securities market in India
FIGURE	87.7% — Percentage of individual equity derivative traders who incurred net losses
FIGURE	92% — Proportion of total losses in equity derivatives attributed to options trading
FIGURE	Rs 24,859 crore — Transaction costs that turned 4.4 lakh profitable traders into net losers

MAINS Q Discuss the risks associated with retail participation in complex derivative products and suggest measures to enhance investor protection in capital markets.

USE: Investor Protection Information Asymmetry Market Volatility Financial Literacy Regulatory Oversight

GROWTH, INFLATION & MACRO INDICATORS

M

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129716**Economists propose OECD countries pay Global South individuals for climate damage**

WHY IN NEWS Economists Michael Greenstone, Abhijit Banerjee, and Esther Duflo proposed a 'Just Economics' model where OECD countries pay Global South individuals directly for climate damages caused by historical emissions.

CONCEPT	Just Economics: A model where OECD countries pay Global South individuals directly for climate damages caused by historical emissions.
CONCEPT	Carbon Pricing: A condition for direct payments, with bilateral deals suggested as an alternative to global consensus.
BODY	OECD: Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, a grouping of mostly wealthy, industrialized countries.
FIGURE	82%: Projected percentage of future global emissions expected to originate outside of OECD countries.
PLACE	Surat: Site of a 99% compliant market trial of 150 textile plants for emissions trading.

MAINS Q Critically analyze the feasibility of direct-to-individual climate reparations from the Global North to the Global South as a mechanism for climate justice.

USE: Climate Justice Carbon Pricing Global South Climate Reparations Market-based Solutions

INFRASTRUCTURE (ENERGY, PORTS, ROADS, RAILWAYS)

P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129698**Railway Board approves first Vande Bharat Sleeper for South India to Mumbai**

WHY IN NEWS The Railway Board approved the first Vande Bharat Sleeper Express connecting KSR Bengaluru to Mumbai (CSMT) to enhance high-speed rail connectivity in South India.

CONCEPT	Vande Bharat Sleeper Express — first such service launched for the South Indian region
BODY	Railway Board — apex body responsible for the management of Indian Railways
PLACE	KSR Bengaluru and CSMT Mumbai — the primary terminals for the new sleeper service

MAINS Q Discuss how the expansion of high-speed rail infrastructure like the Vande Bharat Express contributes to regional integration and economic connectivity in India.

USE: Regional Integration Logistics Efficiency Infrastructure Development Modal Shift Economic Connectivity

CURE Act 2026 shifts Hyderabad property tax to Capital Value System

WHY IN NEWS The introduction of the CURE Act 2026 replaces the GHMC Act 1955, shifting property tax to a Capital Value System and altering local governance in Hyderabad's urban regions.

ACT	CURE Act: Core Urban Region (Integrated Governance) Act, 2026
ACT	GHMC Act, 1955: The previous legislation replaced by the CURE Act
CONCEPT	Capital Value System: A property tax model based on market value rather than annual rental value
PLACE	CMC: Cyberabad Municipal Corporation governed under the new Act

MAINS Q Discuss the implications of shifting to a Capital Value System for property taxation on urban infrastructure development and municipal fiscal autonomy.

USE: Fiscal Federalism Municipal Governance Capital Value System Urban Planning Taxation Policy

Telangana announces ₹52,000 crore infrastructure package for Hyderabad

WHY IN NEWS Deputy CM Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka announced a ₹52,000 crore infrastructure package for Hyderabad to be completed by October 2026, focusing on metro expansion and regional connectivity.

FIGURE	₹52,000 crore — Total infrastructure investment for Hyderabad
FIGURE	₹38,000 crore — Budget for Metro Rail expansion
FIGURE	₹30,627 crore — Budget for Regional Ring Road
CONCEPT	TSRTC-Metro Rail Common Pass — Initiative to integrate public transport
BODY	TSRTC — Telangana State Road Transport Corporation

MAINS Q Discuss how integrated multi-modal transport systems and regional ring roads can alleviate urban congestion and foster economic decentralization in rapidly growing Indian metropolitan hubs.

USE: Multi-modal transport Urban decongestion Regional connectivity Infrastructure investment Transit-oriented development

PNGRB launches National PNG Drive 3.0 to enroll 50 lakh domestic-piped gas connections

WHY IN NEWS PNGRB launched National PNG Drive 3.0 to accelerate domestic piped natural gas (PNG) penetration as part of India's net-zero transition.

BODY	PNGRB — The Petroleum and Natural Gas Regulatory Board is the statutory body regulating the oil and natural gas sector in India.
CONCEPT	National PNG Drive 3.0 — Initiative to accelerate domestic piped natural gas penetration for India's net-zero transition.
FIGURE	50 lakh — Target for domestic-piped gas connections by fiscal year 2027.
FIGURE	40 lakh — Target for connections to be converted into active users.

MAINS Q Examine the role of piped natural gas (PNG) infrastructure in achieving India's net-zero goals and the challenges in transitioning from LPG to PNG.

USE: Net-zero goals Energy transition Last-mile connectivity Regulatory framework Infrastructure development

Karnataka approves Sustainable Data Centre Policy to reach 1GW capacity by 2031

WHY IN NEWS Karnataka approved the Sustainable Data Centre Policy 2026–2031 to establish a 1GW data centre capacity by 2031 while promoting energy and water efficiency.

CONCEPT	PUE (Power Usage Effectiveness) — a metric for data centre energy efficiency
CONCEPT	WUE (Water Usage Effectiveness) — measures water consumption per unit of IT load
SCHEME	Sustainable Data Centre Policy 2026–2031 — provides ₹20 crore incentive for low PUE and ₹30 lakh annual water charge reimbursement
FIGURE	1GW — the target data centre capacity for Karnataka by 2031
PLACE	Karnataka — state approving the policy to become a hub for sustainable digital infrastructure

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of sustainable data infrastructure in India's digital economy and the environmental challenges posed by high-intensity data processing.

USE: Sustainable Infrastructure Digital Economy Resource Efficiency PUE WUE

Agriculture

3

Andhra Pradesh announces ₹2.3 lakh crore for rural development and horticulture

WHY IN NEWS Andhra Pradesh CM N. Chandrababu Naidu announced a massive ₹2.3 lakh crore investment plan for rural development and Rayalaseema horticulture during the Swarnandhra–Swachhandhra Awards–2026.

FIGURE	₹1.30 lakh crore — allocated for rural development in Andhra Pradesh
FIGURE	₹1 lakh crore — allocated specifically for horticulture in Rayalaseema
PLACE	Rayalaseema — a geographical region in the southern part of Andhra Pradesh
CONCEPT	Net-Zero goals — supported via MoU with IIT-Kanpur for schools

MAINS Q Discuss how targeted regional investments in horticulture and rural infrastructure can drive inclusive economic growth and climate resilience in agrarian states like Andhra Pradesh.

USE: Inclusive growth Horticultural development Net-Zero goals Rural infrastructure Regional disparity

Karnataka requests ₹3,705.30 crore aid for ₹46,324.5 crore crop losses

WHY IN NEWS The Karnataka government requested ₹3,705.30 crore in aid from the Centre due to ₹46,324.5 crore in crop losses caused by deficit rainfall.

FIGURE	₹46,324.5 crore — Total crop losses reported in Karnataka due to drought.
PLACE	Karnataka — State facing drought in 177 taluks, with projections of an increase to 220 taluks.
CONCEPT	SDRF — State Disaster Response Fund provides immediate relief for natural calamities.
CONCEPT	NDRF — National Disaster Response Fund is the central fund for disaster management.

MAINS Q Discuss the limitations of current disaster relief funds in addressing large-scale agricultural losses caused by climate-induced droughts in India.

USE: Climate Resilience Disaster Mitigation Fiscal Federalism Agricultural Distress SDRF Norms

Food Ministry reduces sugar stock limits to 1,000 quintals for festival season

WHY IN NEWS The Food Ministry tightened sugar stock-holding limits to 1,000 quintals for a 15-day period starting October 15, 2026, to prevent hoarding and ensure price stability during the festival season.

CONCEPT	Stock-holding limits: Administrative measures to prevent hoarding and ensure price stability.
FIGURE	1,000 quintals: Reduced stock limit for most regions during the festival season.
PLACE	Kolkata and Assam: Exceptions where the sugar stock limit remains at 2,000 quintals.
FIGURE	15% and 28%: Percentage drops in retail and ex-mill sugar prices respectively by October 2026.

MAINS Q Discuss the role of administrative interventions in regulating commodity stock-holding limits to ensure food security and price stability in India.

USE: Price Stability Stock-holding Limits Food Security Market Intervention Supply Chain Management

Science & Technology

7

UNFCCC praises India's Rs 1.86 lakh crore Green Energy Corridor Phase-III

WHY IN NEWS UNFCCC Executive Secretary Simon Stiell praised India's approved Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) for its scale in evacuating renewable energy.

CONCEPT	Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) — A project featuring an intra-state transmission system to evacuate renewable energy.
FIGURE	Rs 1.86 lakh crore — Total project outlay for GEC-III.
FIGURE	135 GW — Target for renewable energy evacuation under GEC-III.
FIGURE	50 GWh — Capacity of battery energy storage systems with a Rs 50,000 crore allocation.
FIGURE	Rs 54,082 crore — Central Financial Assistance (CFA) for GEC-III.

MAINS Q Examine how the development of large-scale battery energy storage systems and transmission corridors can address the intermittency challenges of India's renewable energy transition.

USE: Renewable Energy Transition Grid Stability Energy Storage Systems Decarbonization Infrastructure Development

SpaceX launches first Black woman to lead crew to orbit in record flight

WHY IN NEWS SpaceX successfully launched a four-person crew to the International Space Station (ISS) in a record-breaking 8-hour journey, featuring the first Black woman to lead a crew to orbit.

BODY	SpaceX: A private American aerospace manufacturer and space transportation company.
PLACE	Cape Canaveral Space Force Station: A primary spaceport located in Florida, USA.
CONCEPT	International Space Station (ISS): A modular space station in low Earth orbit for scientific research.
FIGURE	8 hours: The record-breaking flight time achieved to reach the ISS.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of private-public partnerships in space exploration and their role in accelerating technological milestones for humanity.

USE: SpaceX ISS Aerospace Public-Private Partnership Orbital Mechanics

Spintronics AI and CSIR-CEERI sign MoU for indigenous GaN fabrication facility

WHY IN NEWS Spintronics AI and CSIR-CEERI signed an MoU on October 02, 2026, to establish an indigenous Gallium Nitride (GaN) fabrication facility to bolster India's semiconductor manufacturing capabilities.

CONCEPT	Gallium Nitride (GaN) — a wide-bandgap semiconductor material used in high-frequency and high-power electronics.
BODY	CSIR-CEERI — Central Electronics Engineering Research Institute, a premier R&D laboratory under CSIR.
FIGURE	GaN market projection — expected to grow from \$224 million in 2026 to \$1.88 billion by 2033.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of developing indigenous wide-bandgap semiconductor technologies like Gallium Nitride (GaN) for India's technological sovereignty and electronics manufacturing ecosystem.

USE: Semiconductor fabrication Wide-bandgap semiconductors Technological sovereignty Indigenous manufacturing R&D collaboration

CCMB scientists develop India-specific Severity Scores for pediatric patients

WHY IN NEWS CCMB scientists developed India-specific Severity Scores (ISS1 and ISS2) to improve clinical assessment accuracy for pediatric patients.

BODY	CCMB — CSIR-Centre for Cellular and Molecular Biology is a premier research institute in India.
CONCEPT	ISS1 and ISS2 — India-specific Severity Scores designed to improve clinical assessment accuracy.
FIGURE	85% — The concordance rate achieved by ISS scores compared to 67% for PSS scores.
PLACE	Nagpur — Site of the study at Government Medical College and Hospital.

MAINS Q Discuss the importance of developing indigenous clinical assessment tools in improving healthcare outcomes for vulnerable populations in India.

USE: Clinical Concordance Diagnostic Standardization Indigenous Innovation Pediatric Healthcare Public Health Metrics

Tamil Nadu launches first booth-less toll plaza using FASTag and ANPR

WHY IN NEWS Tamil Nadu launched its first booth-less toll plaza at Paranur using FASTag, RFID, and ANPR technology to automate toll collection and reduce traffic congestion.

CONCEPT	ANR (Automatic Number Plate Recognition) — uses Optical Character Recognition (OCR) to identify vehicle plates
PLACE	Paranur toll plaza — located on the Chennai-Tiruchi National Highway in Tamil Nadu
FIGURE	100% penalty — applied for users without tags or sufficient balance
FIGURE	50% discount — applicable on the penalty fee if paid within 72 hours of the e-notice

MAINS Q Discuss how the integration of RFID and ANPR technologies in infrastructure projects can enhance logistical efficiency and reduce carbon footprints in India's transport sector.

USE: Multi-lane free flow Logistical efficiency Carbon footprint Automated enforcement Digital infrastructure

Gursaran Prasad Talwar pioneered leprosy and birth control vaccines

WHY IN NEWS The upcoming centenary of Gursaran Prasad Talwar, a pioneer in immunology who developed the first leprosy and birth control vaccines and founded the National Institute of Immunology (NII).

PERSON	Gursaran Prasad Talwar — Pioneer in immunology who developed first leprosy and birth control vaccines.
MISSION	National Institute of Immunology (NII) — Founded in 1983 in New Delhi following consultations with Indira Gandhi.
DATE	1983 — Year the National Institute of Immunology (NII) was established.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of indigenous vaccine development and institutional research in strengthening India's public health infrastructure and achieving universal health coverage.

USE: [Immunology](#) [Vaccine Development](#) [Public Health Infrastructure](#) [Neglected Tropical Diseases](#) [Biotechnology](#)

Google launches Planet Labs satellite to test Tensor Processing Unit in orbit

WHY IN NEWS Google launched a Planet Labs satellite via a SpaceX rocket to test its Tensor Processing Unit (TPU) in orbit as part of Project Suncatcher.

CONCEPT	Tensor Processing Unit (TPU) — Google's custom-developed AI accelerator chip for machine learning workloads.
MISSION	Project Suncatcher — Google's initiative to build an 81-satellite network for orbital compute clusters.
CONCEPT	Laser communications — Proposed technology for future purpose-built satellites to collaborate in orbit.
REPORT	Joule white paper — Predicts SpaceX's Starship could achieve a launch cost of \$200 per kilogram by 2035.

MAINS Q Discuss the significance of orbital computing and space-based AI infrastructure in the evolution of global data processing and high-performance computing.

USE: [Orbital Computing](#) [Tensor Processing Unit](#) [Space Infrastructure](#) [Edge Computing](#) [Space AI](#)

Environment & Ecology

4

Idukki administration clears natural passages to mitigate human-wildlife conflicts

WHY IN NEWS The Idukki district administration and Forest Department are clearing natural passages in the Devikulam forest range to mitigate escalating human-wildlife conflicts.

PLACE	Chinnakkanal and Devikulam forest range — locations in Idukki district, Kerala where passages are being cleared.
CONCEPT	Human-wildlife conflict — resulted in 81 deaths and 486 injuries over a decade in the region.
FIGURE	10 deaths — recorded specifically during the 2023-24 period in the area.

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological and socio-economic challenges of human-wildlife conflict in fragmented habitats and evaluate the efficacy of translocation as a mitigation strategy.

USE: [Human-wildlife conflict](#) [Habitat fragmentation](#) [Wildlife translocation](#) [Corridor restoration](#) [Biodiversity conservation](#)

Survey records 65 distinct vultures in Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary

WHY IN NEWS A synchronous survey in Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary recorded 65 vultures, providing critical baseline data for monitoring critically endangered scavengers in the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve.

PLACE	Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary — located within the Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve in Kerala
CONCEPT	White-rumped vulture (<i>Gyps bengalensis</i>) and Red-headed vulture (<i>Gyps bengalensis</i>) — critically endangered scavengers
FIGURE	65 distinct vultures — recorded across seven vantage points during the survey

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological significance of vultures in waste management and the primary threats leading to their population decline in the Indian subcontinent.

USE: Biodiversity conservation Scavenger ecology Zoonotic disease Habitat fragmentation Critically endangered

Union Minister and West Bengal CM release tigress T138 into Buxa Tiger Reserve

WHY IN NEWS Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav and West Bengal CM Suvenhu Adhikari released tigress T138 from Valmiki Tiger Reserve to Buxa Tiger Reserve to mark the start of World Wildlife Week 2026.

MISSION	Tiger population augmentation project — Spans financial years 2023–24 to 2027–28
EVENT	World Wildlife Week 2026 — Commenced on October 02, 2026

MAINS Q Discuss the ecological and logistical challenges involved in tiger translocation projects to ensure the long-term survival of relocated individuals in new habitats.

USE: Translocation Habitat Augmentation Biodiversity Conservation In-situ Conservation Wildlife Management

IMD reports 2026 as lowest monsoon in a decade due to El Nino

WHY IN NEWS The India Meteorological Department (IMD) reported that 2026 recorded the lowest monsoon rainfall in a decade due to a strengthening El Nino and a neutral Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD).

CONCEPT	El Nino — climate pattern characterized by the warming of the central and eastern equatorial Pacific Ocean
CONCEPT	Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) — remained neutral during the 2026 monsoon season
FIGURE	759.4 mm — India's 2026 monsoon rainfall, representing 87% of the 868.6 mm Long Period Average
BODY	India Meteorological Department (IMD) — primary agency for monitoring and forecasting monsoon patterns
EVENT	East and Northeast India recorded 1,016.3 mm of rainfall, the lowest since 1901

MAINS Q Analyze the impact of El Nino and the Indian Ocean Dipole on India's monsoon patterns and discuss strategies to mitigate drought-induced agricultural risks.

USE: El Nino Indian Ocean Dipole Monsoon Deficit Climate Variability Drought Threshold

LEFT-WING EXTREMISM P

2 Oct · The Hindu · satyadheesh.in/news/129436

Manipur Cabinet approves ₹10 lakh assistance for kin of missing persons

WHY IN NEWS The Manipur Cabinet approved financial assistance for kin of missing persons and increased ex-gratia for security forces amidst the ongoing ethnic conflict.

FIGURE | ₹10 lakh — One-time assistance for kin of missing persons

CONCEPT | Ethnic conflict — Resulted in 306 deaths and over 60,000 displacements

MAINS Q Discuss the challenges in managing internal ethnic conflicts and the role of state-central coordination in ensuring the safety of displaced populations in Manipur.

USE: Internal Security Ethnic Conflict Displacement Ex-gratia Law and Order

10 questions, 10 minutes

Answers at the bottom, upside down

1 With reference to the electoral roll in India, consider the following statements:

1. The special drive to re-enroll voters was initiated after 5 crore names were deleted.
2. The Election Commission of India is a statutory body responsible for state elections.
3. Form 6 is the application form used for the enrollment of new voters.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 3 only ☐ b 1 and 2 only
☐ c 2 and 3 only ☐ d 1, 2 and 3

2 What percentage of the total losses in equity derivatives was specifically attributed to options trading?

- ☐ a 92% ☐ b 60%
☐ c 75% ☐ d 87.7%

3 Which of the following glaciers was identified as a strategic geographical feature in the Ladakh region?

- ☐ a Siachen ☐ b Yamunotri
☐ c Gangotri ☐ d Parpik

4 With reference to India's Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III), consider the following statements:

1. The project aims to evacuate 135 GW of renewable energy.
2. The scheme allocates Rs 50,000 crore for 100 GWh of battery energy storage systems.
3. The total project outlay for GEC-III is Rs 1.86 lakh crore.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 1 only ☐ b 2 only
☐ c 1 and 3 only ☐ d 2 and 3 only

5 With reference to the recent SpaceX mission to the International Space Station (ISS), consider the following statements:

1. The mission reached the ISS in a record-breaking 8-hour flight time.
2. The flight took a total of 12 hours to reach the orbital station.
3. The crew was launched from Cape Canaveral Space Force Station in Florida.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 1 and 2 only ☐ b 1 and 3 only
☐ c 2 and 3 only ☐ d 1, 2 and 3

6 With reference to the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA) between India and Canada, consider the following statements:

1. The current bilateral trade baseline between the two nations is USD 50 billion.
2. The negotiations aim to increase bilateral trade to USD 70 billion by 2031.
3. The fifth round of CEPA negotiations is scheduled to take place in Ottawa.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- ☐ a 1 only ☐ b 1 and 2 only
☐ c 1 and 3 only ☐ d 2 and 3 only

7 With reference to the rural development investments in Andhra Pradesh, consider the following statements:

1. The government allocated ₹1.30 lakh crore specifically for horticulture in the Rayalaseema region.
2. The investment plan was announced during the Swarnandhra-Swachhandhra Awards-2020.
3. A total of ₹2.3 lakh crore was announced for rural development and Rayalaseema horticulture.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1 and 3 only

8 How many buses are covered under the Vетtri Payanam scheme in Tamil Nadu?

- (a) 8,432 (b) 12,695
(c) 10,000 (d) 15,200

9 Which intergovernmental organization did the bilateral talks precede before the summit in New Delhi?

- (a) G20 (b) BRICS
(c) SCO (d) QUAD

10 With reference to the Gujarat Uniform Civil Code Bill 2026, consider the following statements:

1. The bill unifies rules for marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships.
2. The bill explicitly excludes Scheduled Tribes to preserve their customary rights.
3. The bill mandates marriage registration within 30 days of the wedding.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWERS • 1 (a) 2 (a) 3 (d) 4 (c) 5 (b) 6 (d) 7 (b) 8 (b) 9 (b) 10 (c)



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